Phases of the Moon

Let Us Discuss

Does the moon look the same every day? Observe the moon in the sky every night for fifteen days and find out.



The moon appears to change shape every night. On the night when we see it in its complete form, it is called the full moon (Pournami).

On the night when we cannot see the moon at all (even when the sky is clear), it is called the new moon (Amavasai).

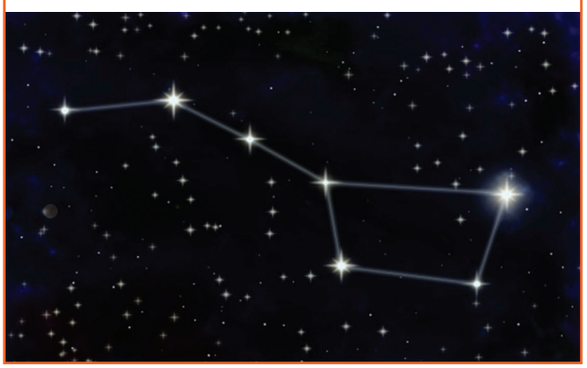
Many festivals are celebrated based on the phases of the moon - e.g., Eid, Mahalaya Amavasai.

DO YOU KNOW? Neil Armstrong was the first man to step on the moon.

The Stars

There are countless stars in the sky. The Sun is the nearest star. The stars shine during the day too, but we cannot see their light because the Sun is much brighter than the other stars. We see that a group of stars appears to form a pattern in the sky. Have you seen any star patterns?

Observe the example given below.



DO YOU KNOW? The position of the pattern of stars helped people to know when to sow and harvest crops. They also helped to people find directions during travel.

Match the following.

a) Sun	-	a dark area that travels with me
b) Stars	-	does not have its own light
c) Moon	-	form patterns
d) Shadow	-	helps plants grow

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